MASTERING GOOGLE FORMS

How to create google forms

SUBMITTED

(AS FINAL PROJECT WORK II)

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Welcome to the Google Forms Mastery Guide!

Google Forms is a powerful, free and zero-code (i.e. a user can build a fully functional data-collection without writing a single line of traditional programming code) tool used to create surveys, registrations, and quizzes.

In 2025, you do not need to be a "tech expert" to build professional forms. Whether you are a teacher, a business owner, or just organizing a party, this tool helps you collect information quickly and keep it organized.

1.2 Why Use Google Forms?

- **No Coding Needed** : You can build a complete form just by clicking and dragging. No special computer skills are required.
- **Smart Help**: You can tell the built-in AI what you need (like "make a birthday invite"), and it will suggest the questions for you.
- **Saves Time**: All answers are saved, automatically, into a Google Sheet. You never have to type out responses by hand.
- **Work Together**: You can invite friends or coworkers to help you build the form at the same time.

1.3 What You Will Learn in This Manual

This guide will show you how to:

- **Start Your Form**: Use the Template Gallery to find a pre-made design or start from scratch.

- **Add Questions**: Learn how to add multiple-choice, checkboxes, and rating scales.
- **Use Smart Logic**: Send people to different pages based on the answers they give.
- **Share and See Results**: Send your form out and view the answers in easy-to-read charts.

1.4 What You Need to Begin

To use Google Forms, you only need two things:

- A free Google Account (Gmail).
- An internet connection.

There is nothing to download or install. Just go to forms.google.com to start!

2. CREATING YOUR FIRST FORM

2.1 Choosing a Template vs. Blank Form

Note: For full experience on your mobile device, you need to switch your browser to desktop site. To get this done, click the three dots at the top right corner of the browser, scroll down until you see the desktop site and check the box.

- **Blank Form**: Here, you can start from scratch for total control. Go to forms.new to begin.

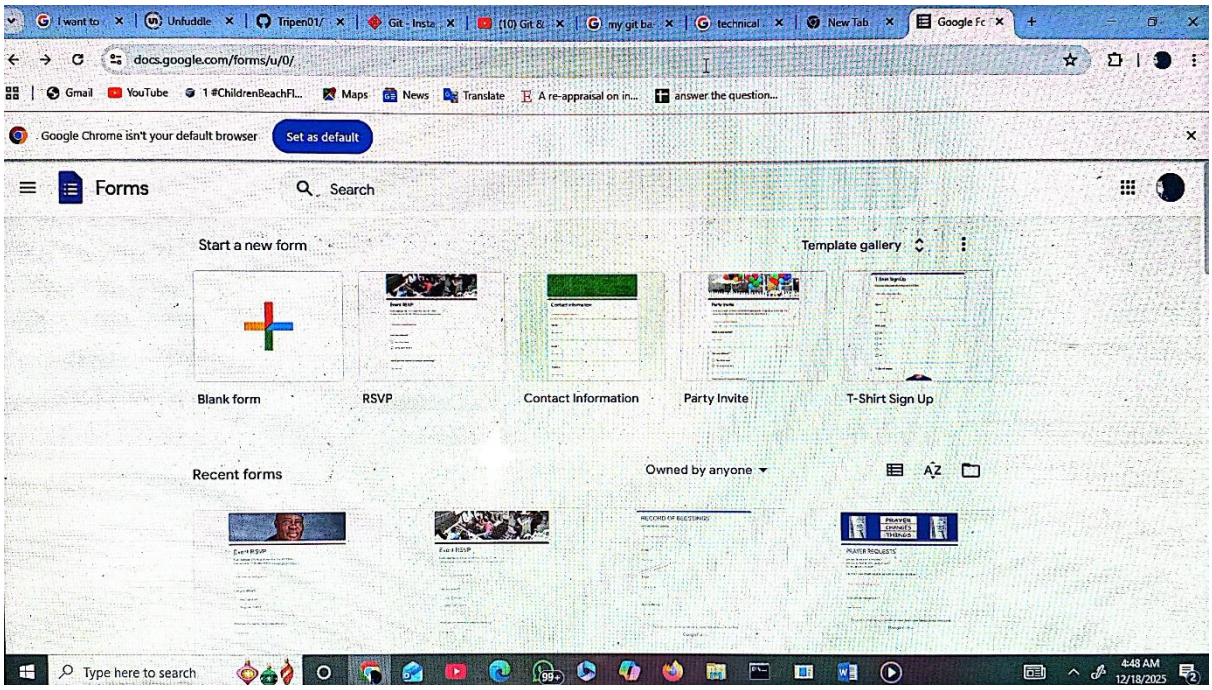

Figure 1: Blank Form and Templates

- **Templates**: Use the "Template Gallery" for pre-made layouts like "Event Registration" or "Work Request." This saves time on formatting and logic.

2.2 Naming Your Form and Adding a Description

Click on "Untitled Form" in the top-left corner to give your file a name. Then, click the large title in the center of the page to give it a public name. Use the Description field to tell respondents why you are collecting this data.

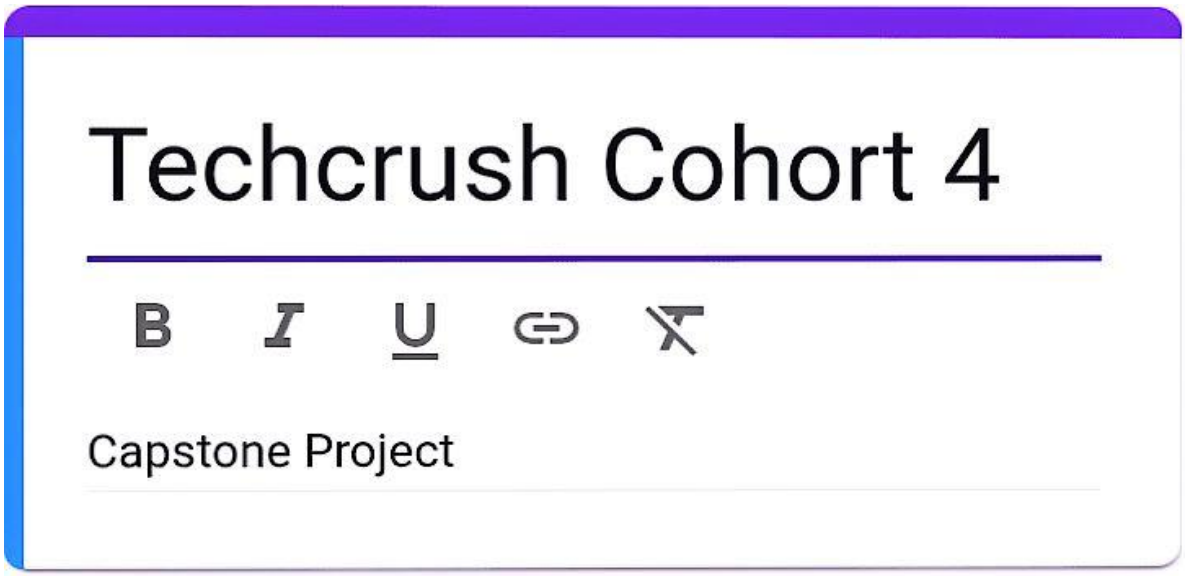

Figure 2: Naming the form

3. DESIGNING QUESTIONS

3.1 Question Types

- **Short Answer/Paragraph**: For text-based responses.

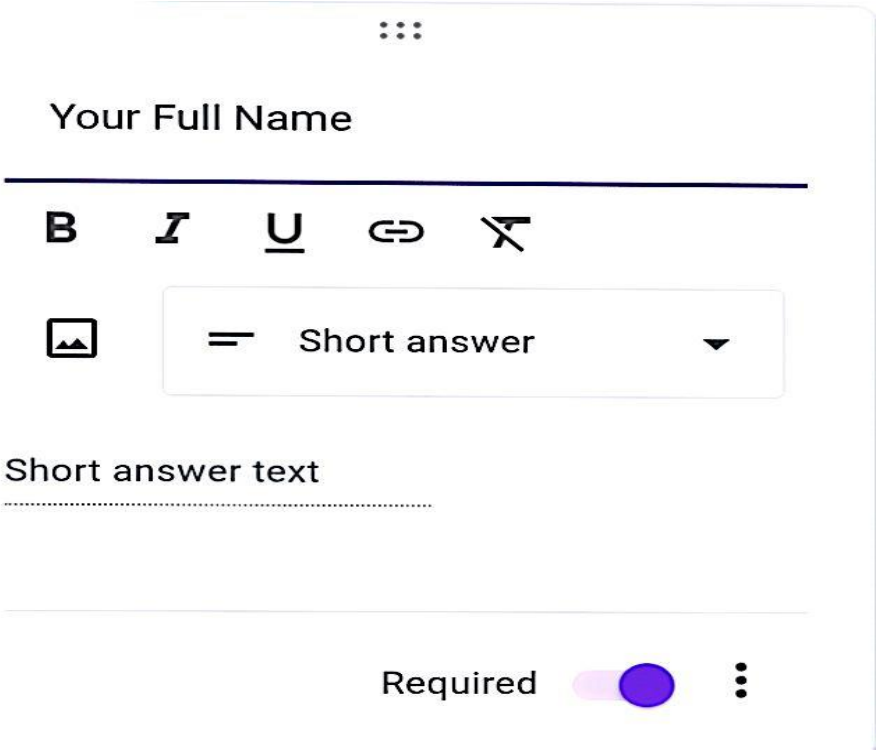

Figure 3: Short answer

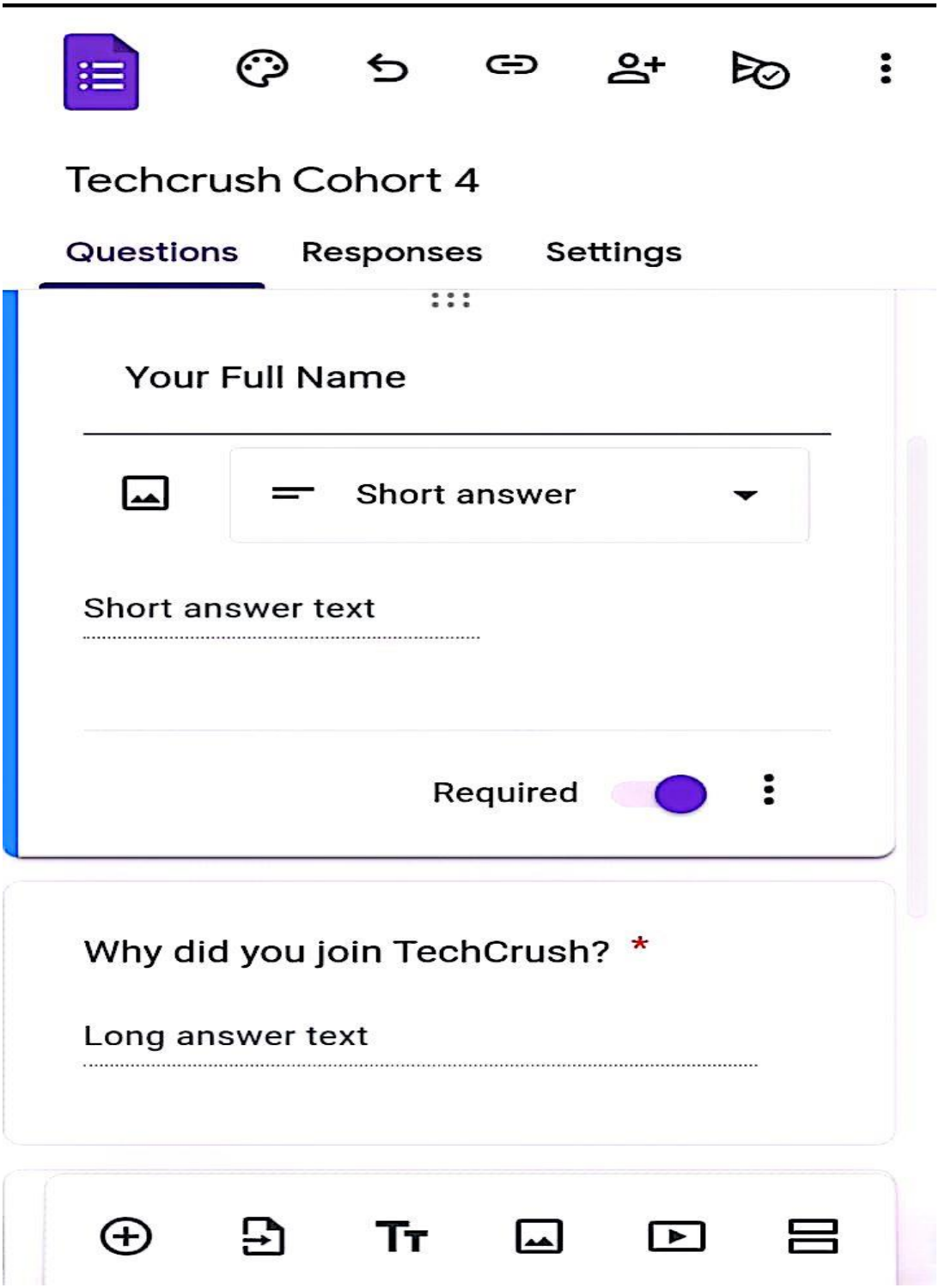

Figure 4: Long answer

- **Multiple Choice**: Users select one option from a list.

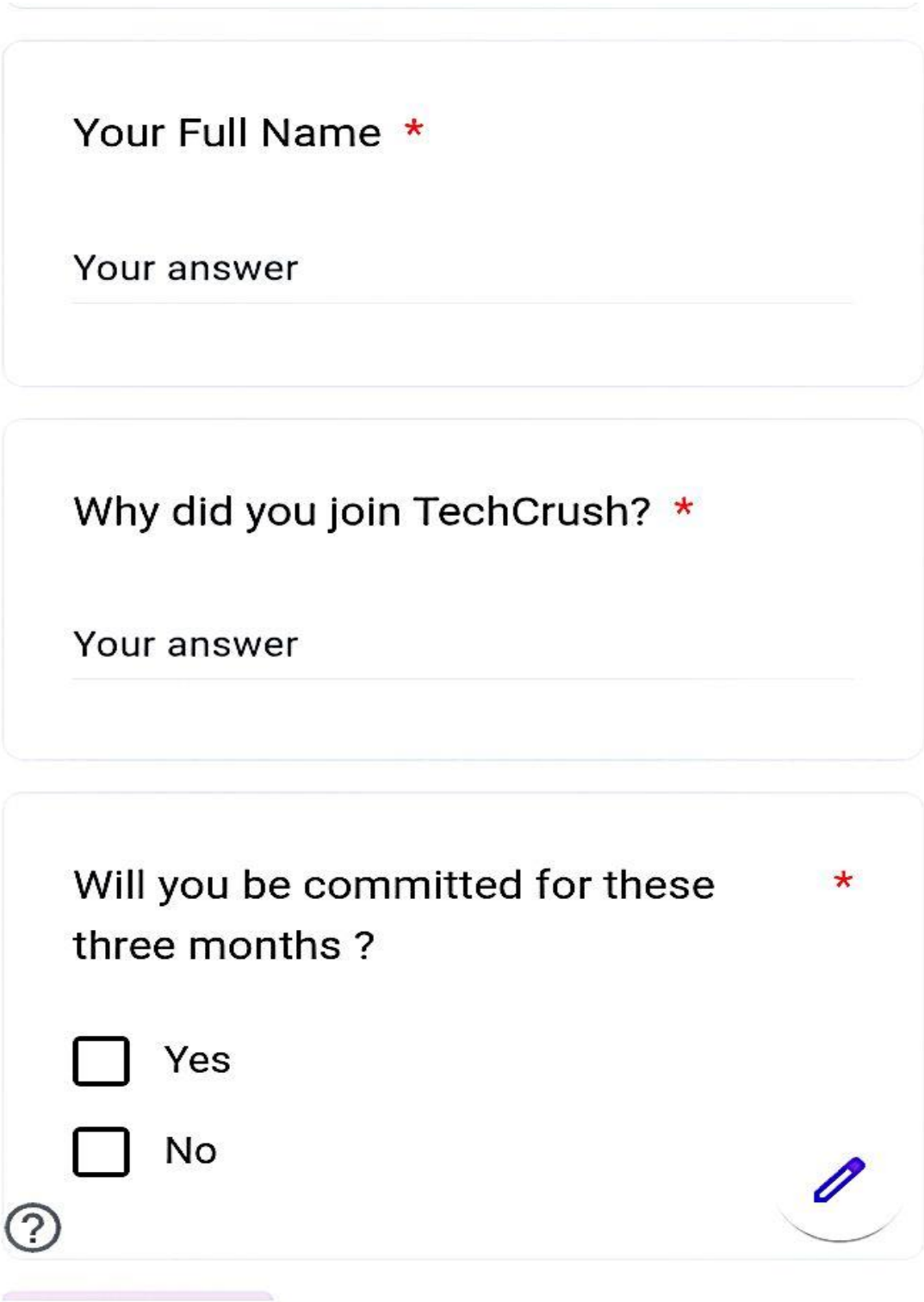

Figure 5: Multiple choice

- **Linear Scale**: Perfect for ratings (e.g., "Rate your experience from 1 to 5").

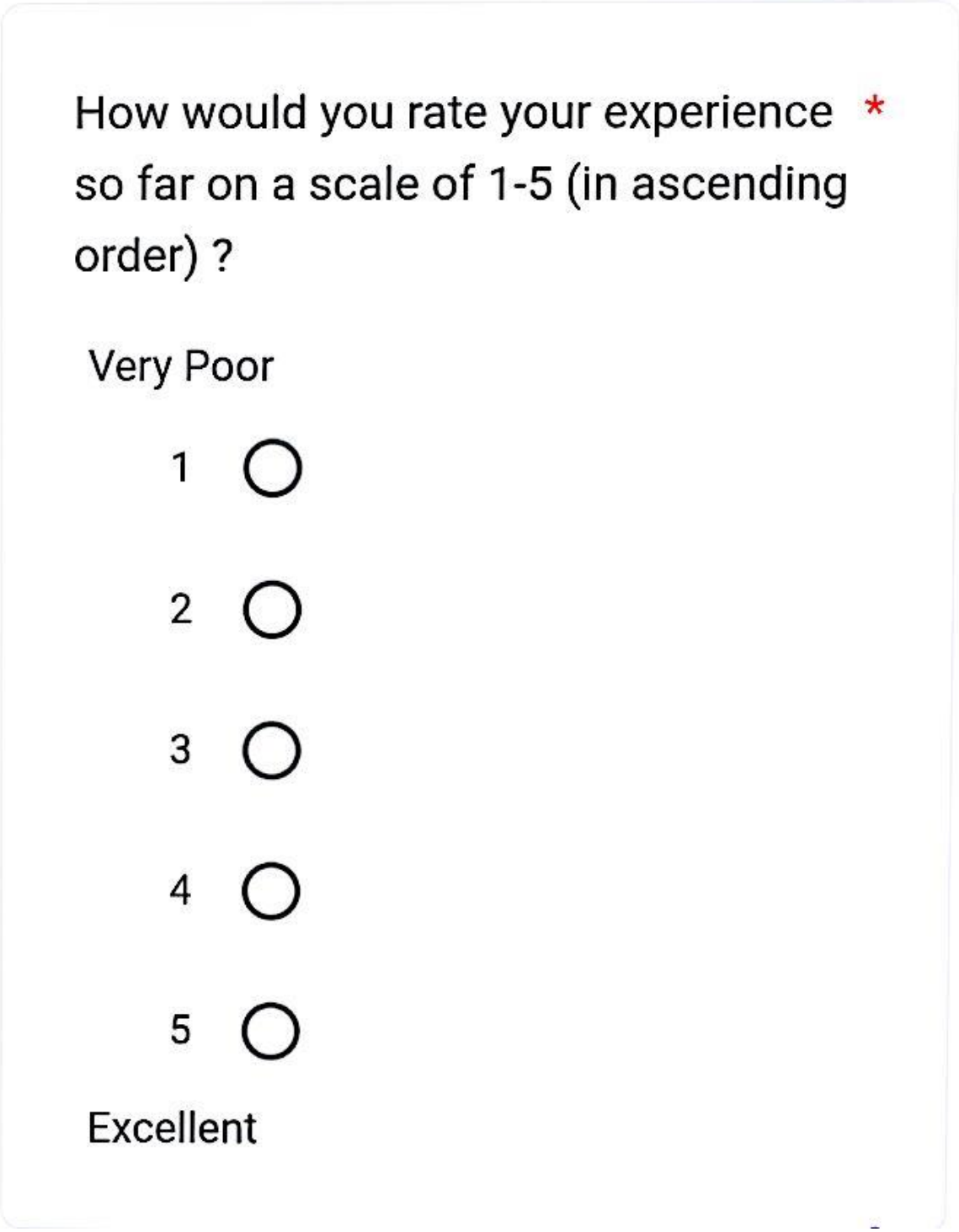

Figure 6: Linear scale

- Checkbox : Users can select multiple options

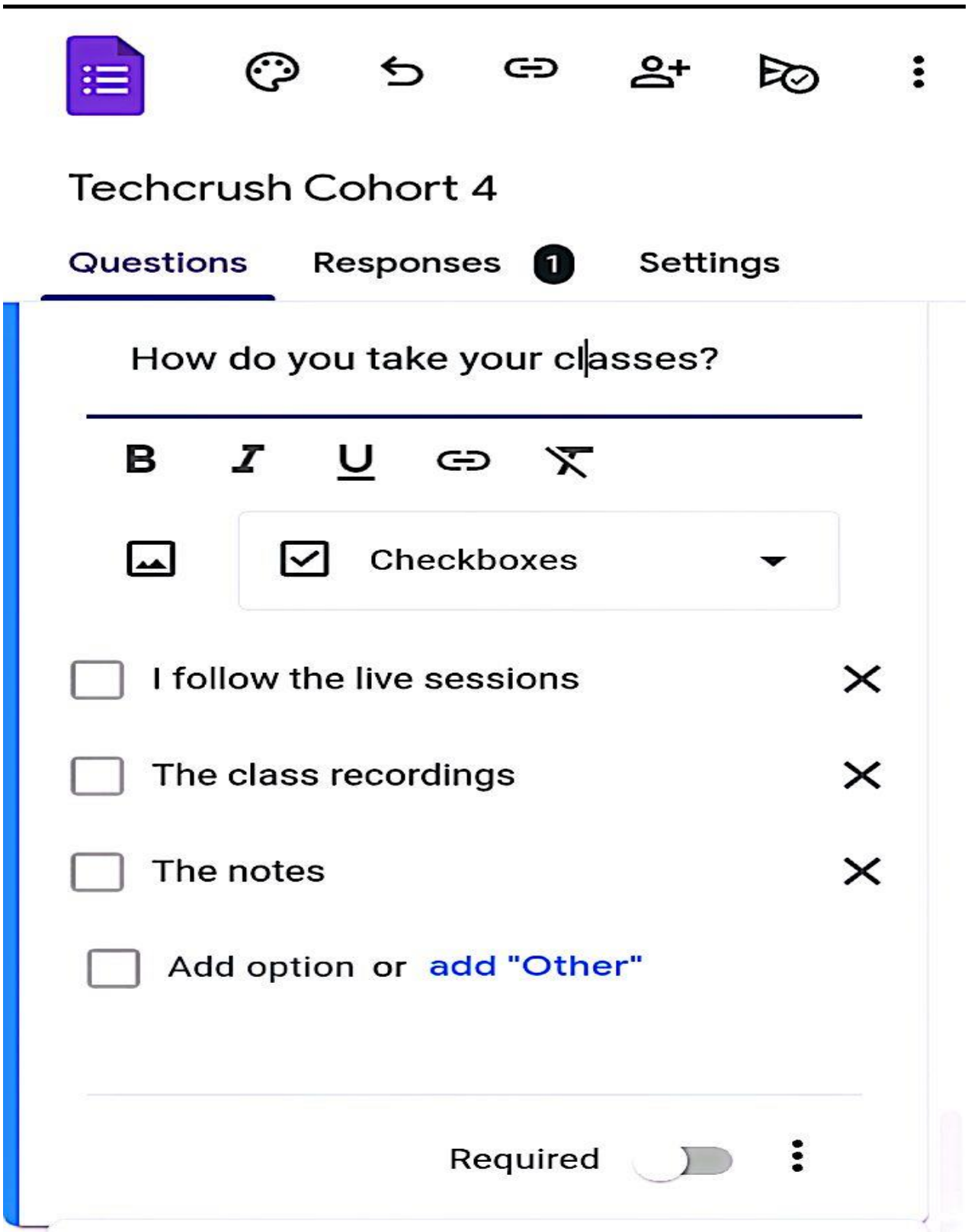

Figure 7: Checkbox

- **Rating** : Users can select just one option

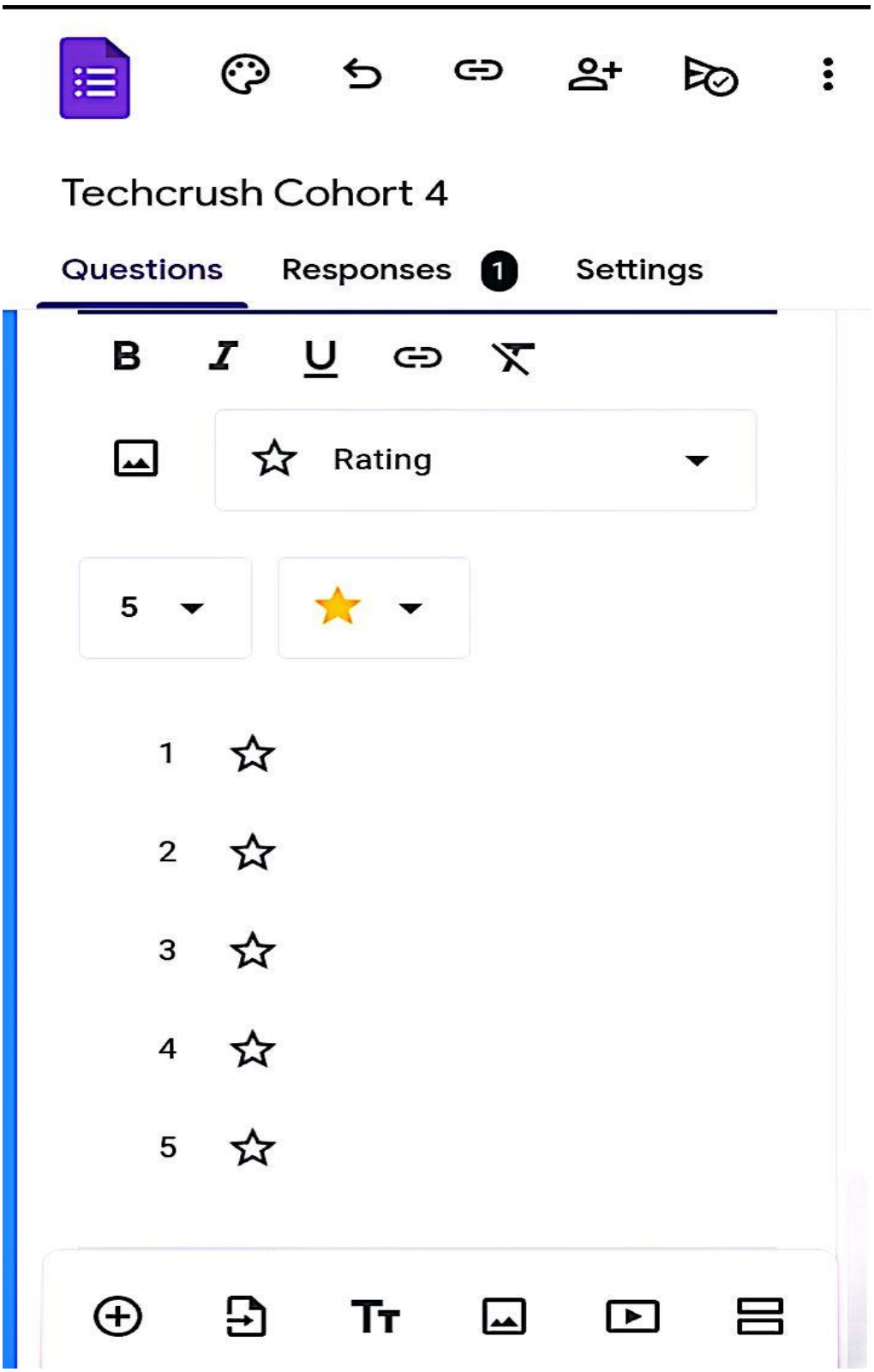

Figure 8 : Rating

3.2 Setting "Required" Fields

Toggle the Required switch at the bottom right of any question. This prevents users from submitting the form until that specific question is answered.

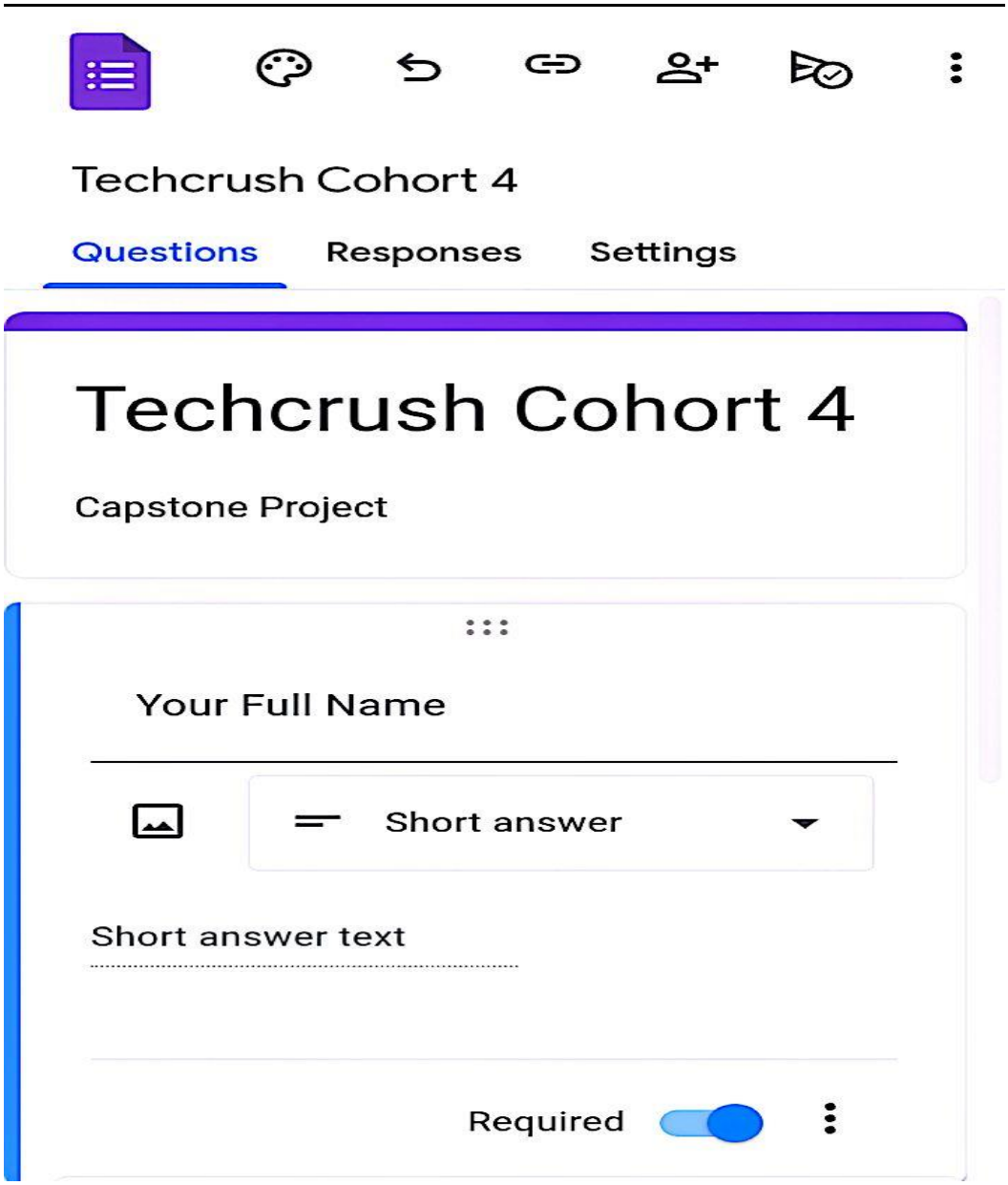

Figure 9: Required switch

3.3 Adding Images and Videos

Figure 10: The floating sidebar

Enhance your form by clicking the Image icon or Video icon in the floating sidebar. This is useful for "Identify this image" questions in quizzes.

4. ADVANCED ORGANIZATION

4.1 Using Sections

Click the two rectangles icon (Add Section) in the sidebar. Sections break long forms into multiple pages, making them less intimidating for users.

Figure 11: Two rectangles icon

4.2 Logic Branching

Click the three dots on a Multiple Choice question and select "Go to section based on answer." This allows you to skip irrelevant questions for certain users (e.g., if they answer "No," skip to the end).

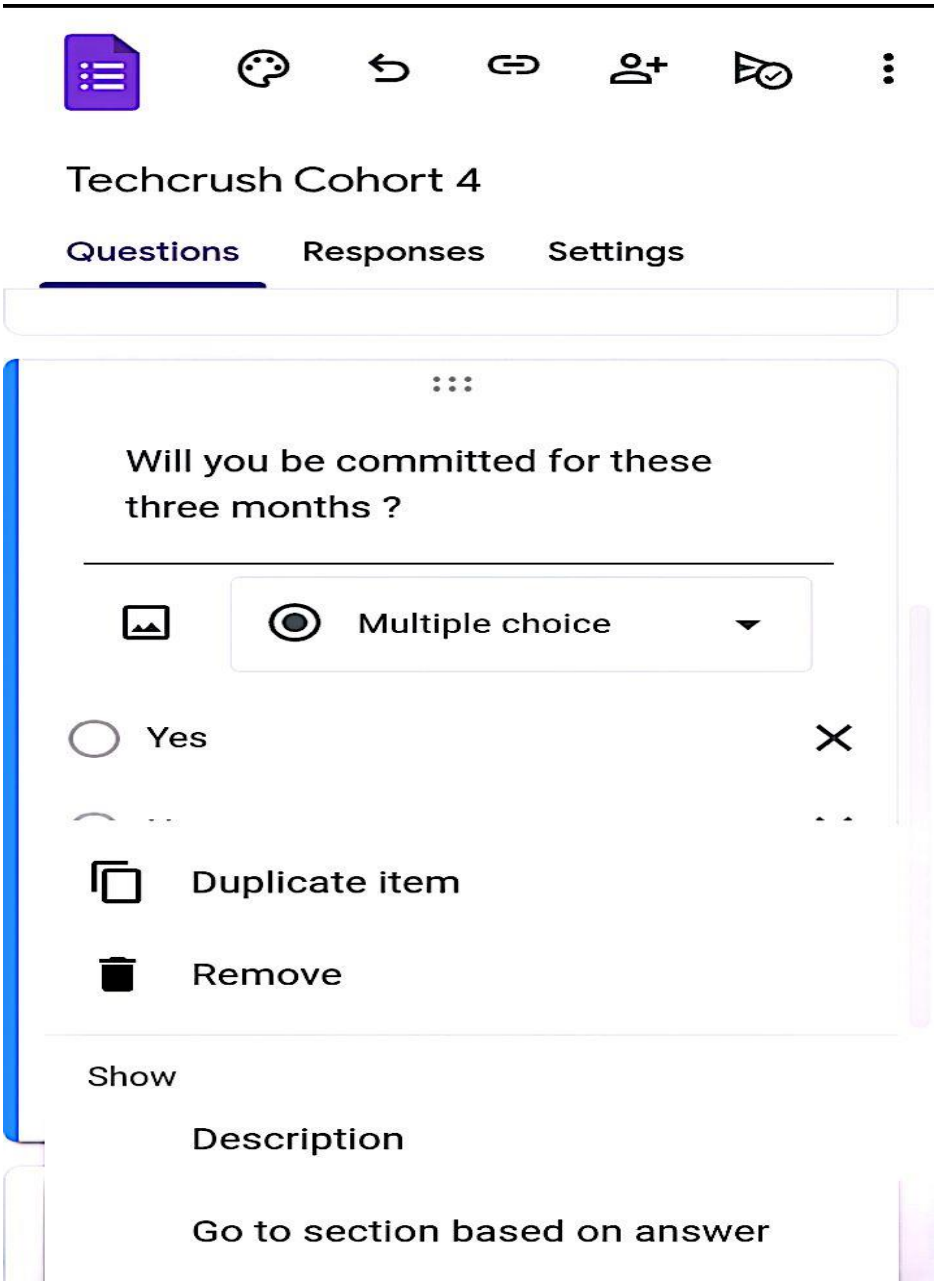

Figure 12: Logic branching

5. CUSTOMIZING APPEARANCE

- Click the **Paint Palette icon** (Themes) at the top.

Figure 13: Paint Palette icon

- **Header Image**: Upload your company logo.
- **Colors/Fonts**: Choose colors that match your brand. Google Forms will automatically suggest colors that complement your header image.

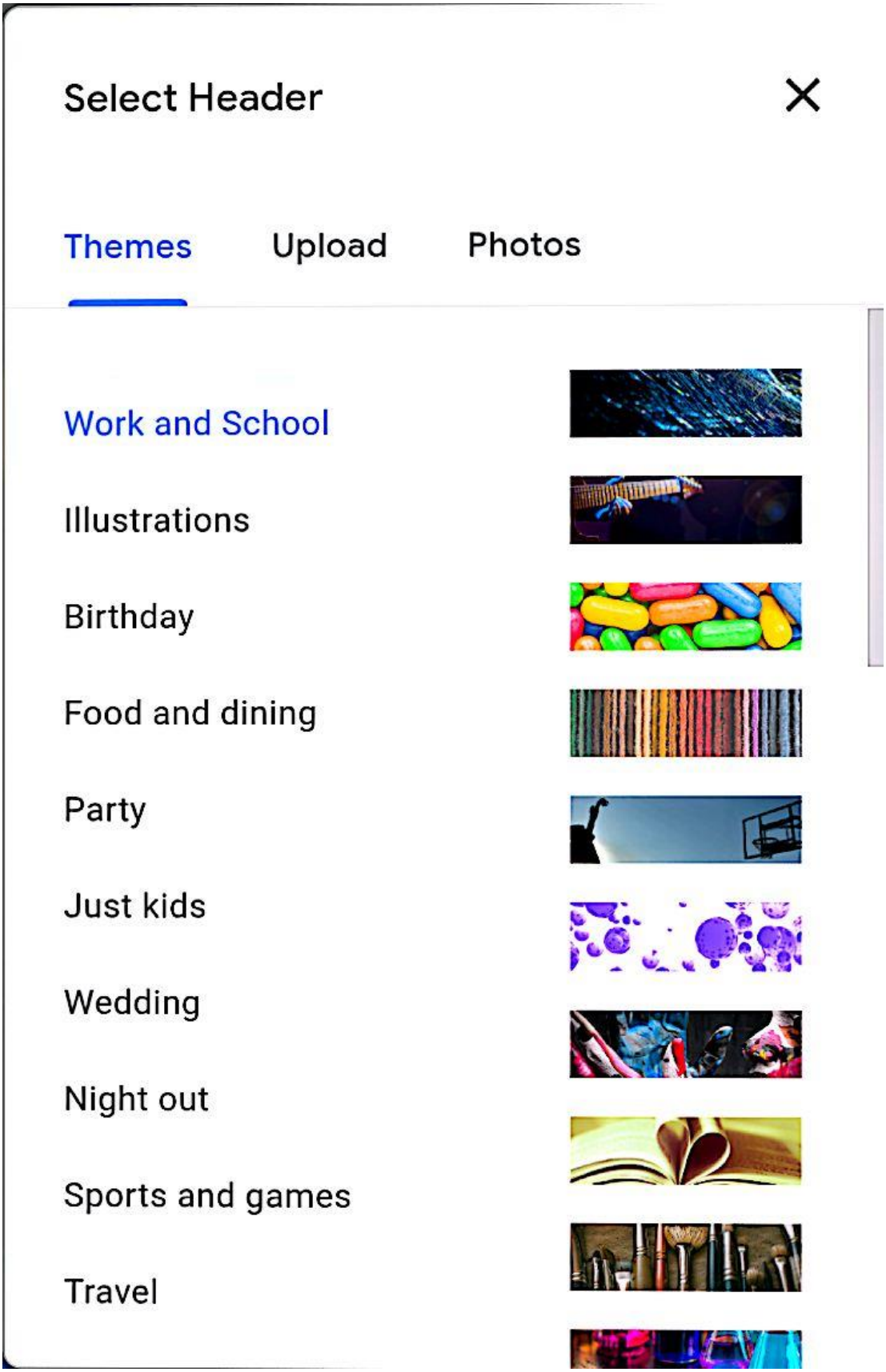

Figure 14: Header

6. FORM SETTINGS & QUIZZES

6.1 Setting Up Self-Grading Quizzes

Go to Settings > Make this a quiz. You can then assign point values to questions and provide "Answer Keys" so the form grades itself instantly.

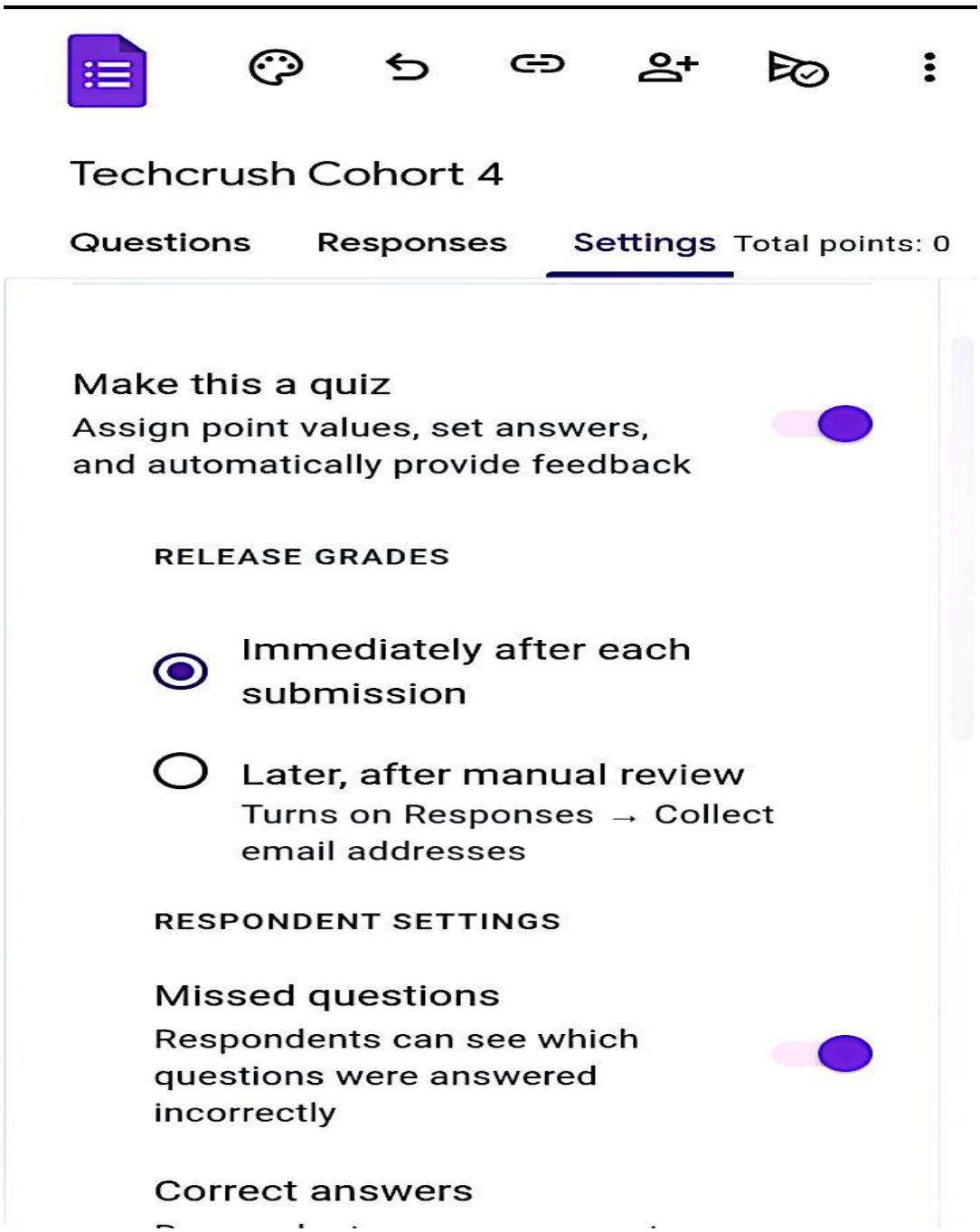

Figure 15: "Make the form a quiz"

6.2 Managing Responses

In Settings, you can choose to:

- Collect email addresses automatically.
- Limit to one response per person (requires Google login).
- Allow response editing after submission

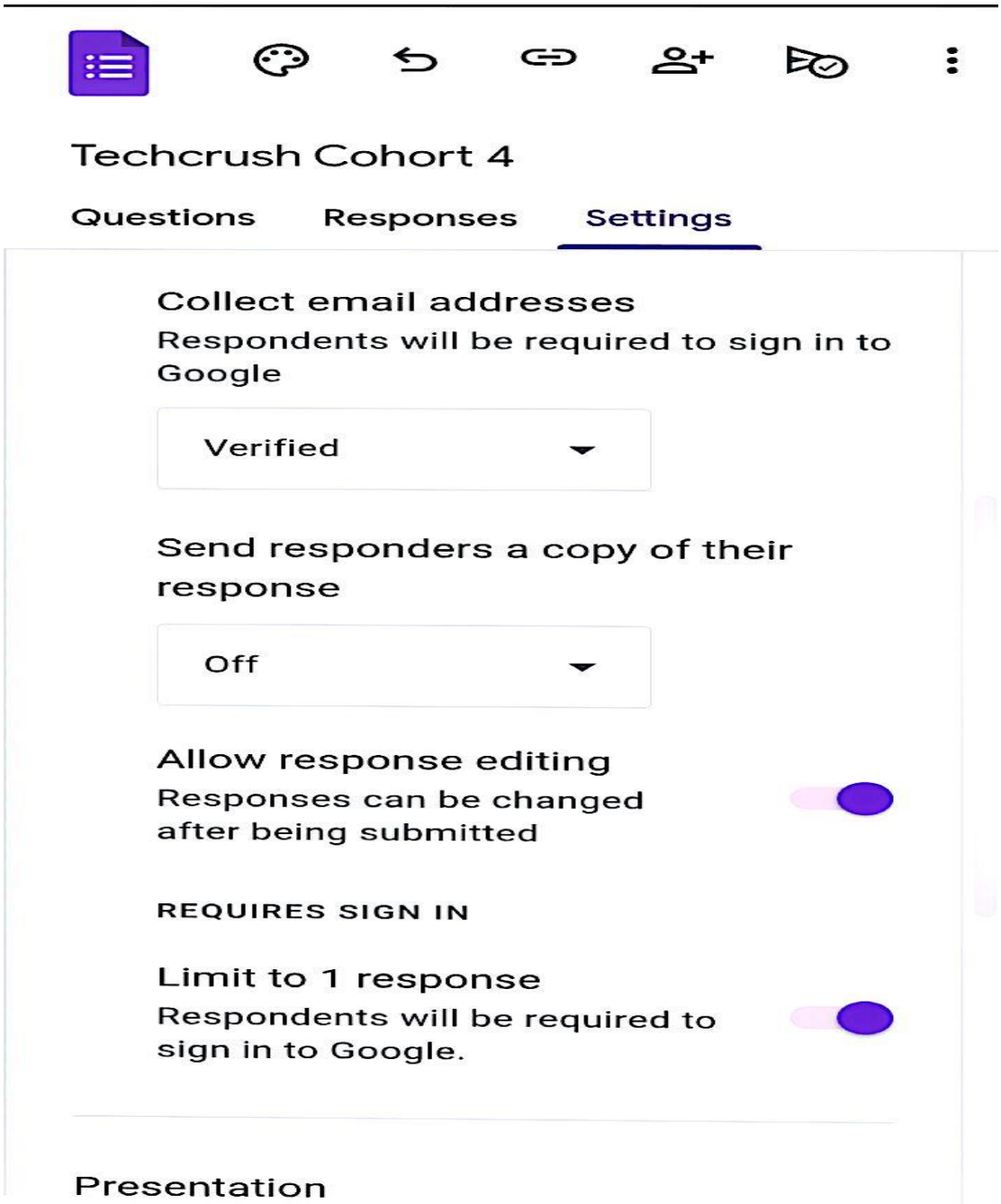

Figure 16: Managing responses

7. SHARING AND DISTRIBUTION

- Click the Send button.
- Email: Send directly to specific people.

Figure 17 : The top section containing the send button

- **Link**: Copy the URL (use "Shorten URL" for a cleaner link).

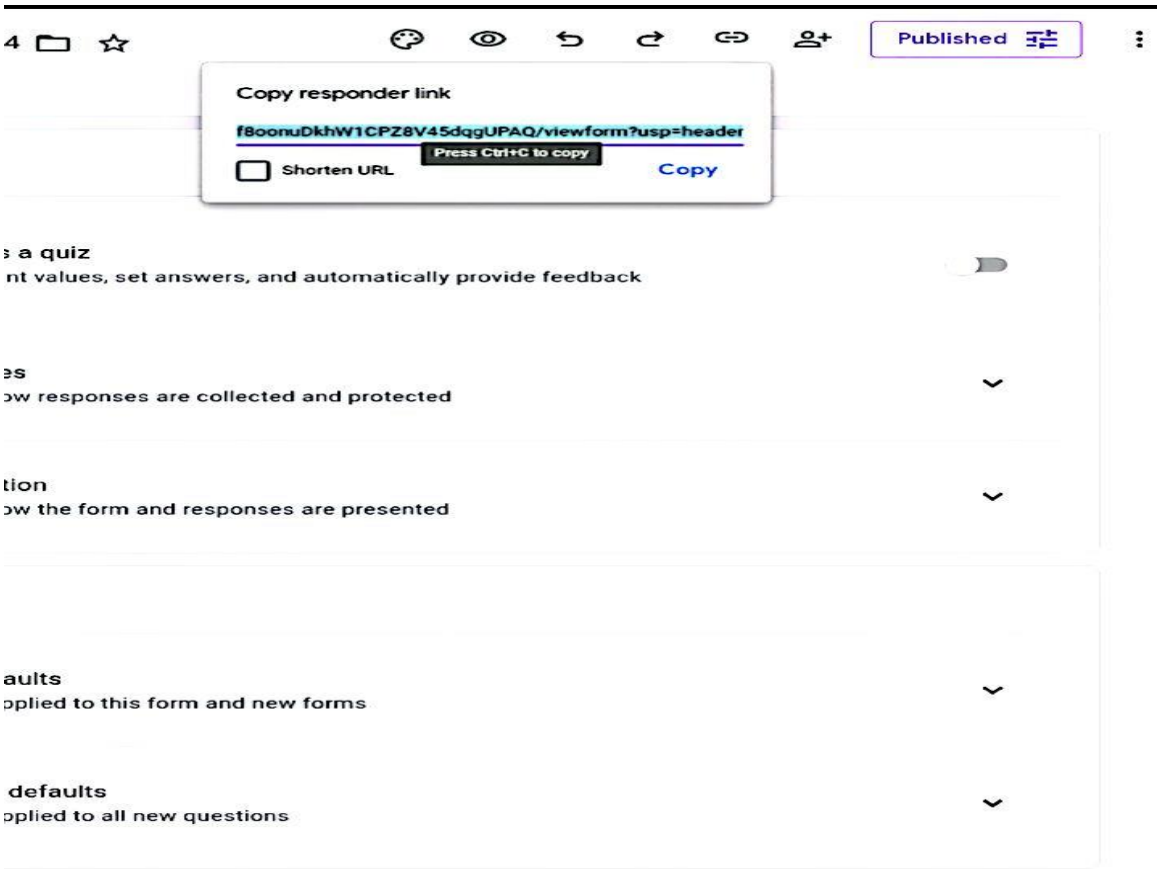

Figure 18: Copying the link (press shorten URL for a cleaner link)

- **Embed:** Copy the HTML code to put the form directly on your website.

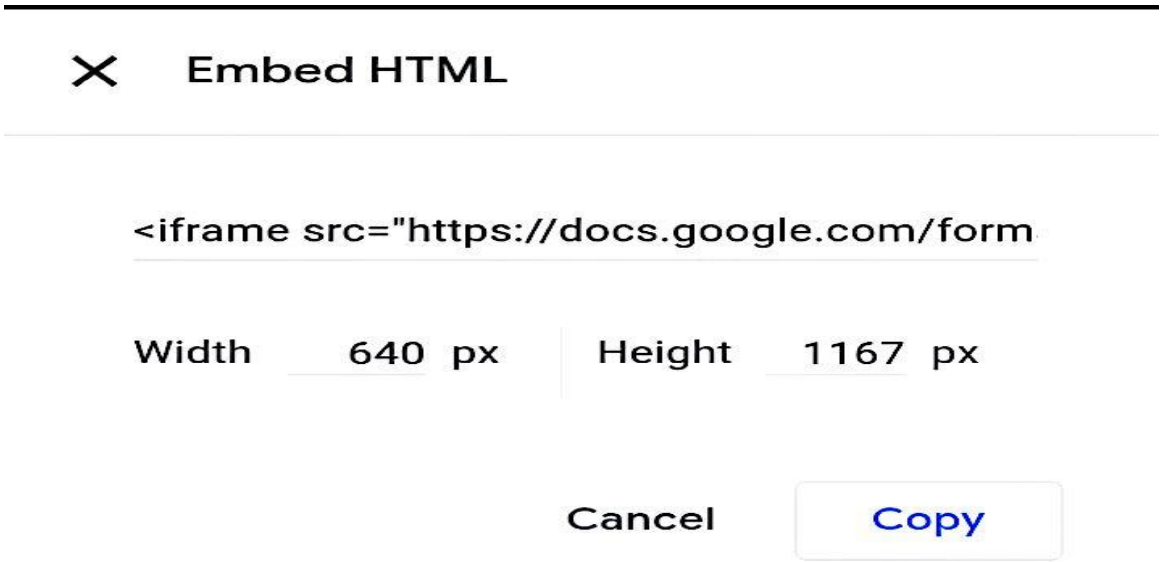

Figure 19 : Embedding HTML

8. VIEWING AND ANALYZING DATA

8.1 Summaries and Individual Responses

- Click the Responses tab.

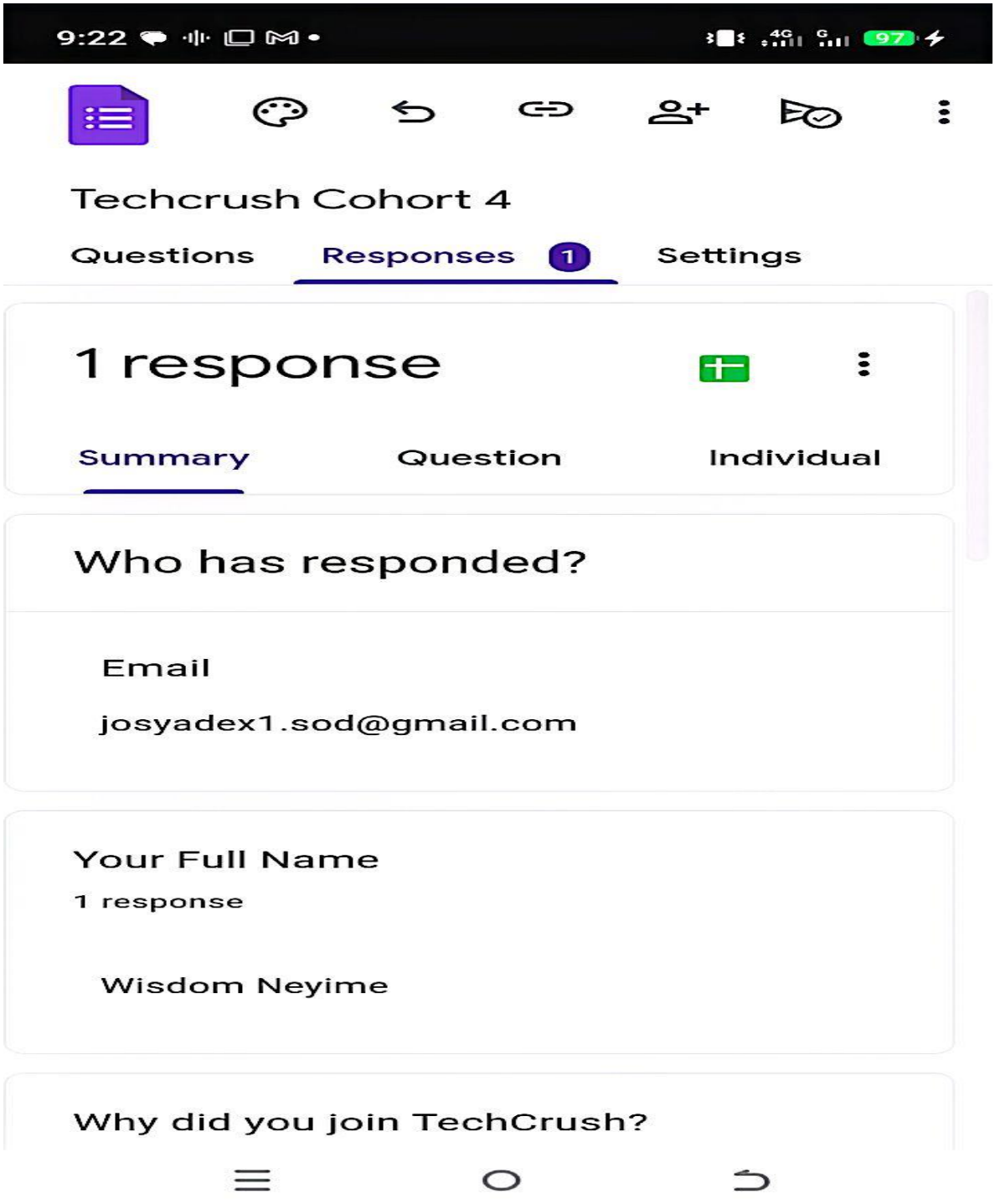

Figure 20 : Handling responses

- Summary: View colorful pie charts and graphs of all data.

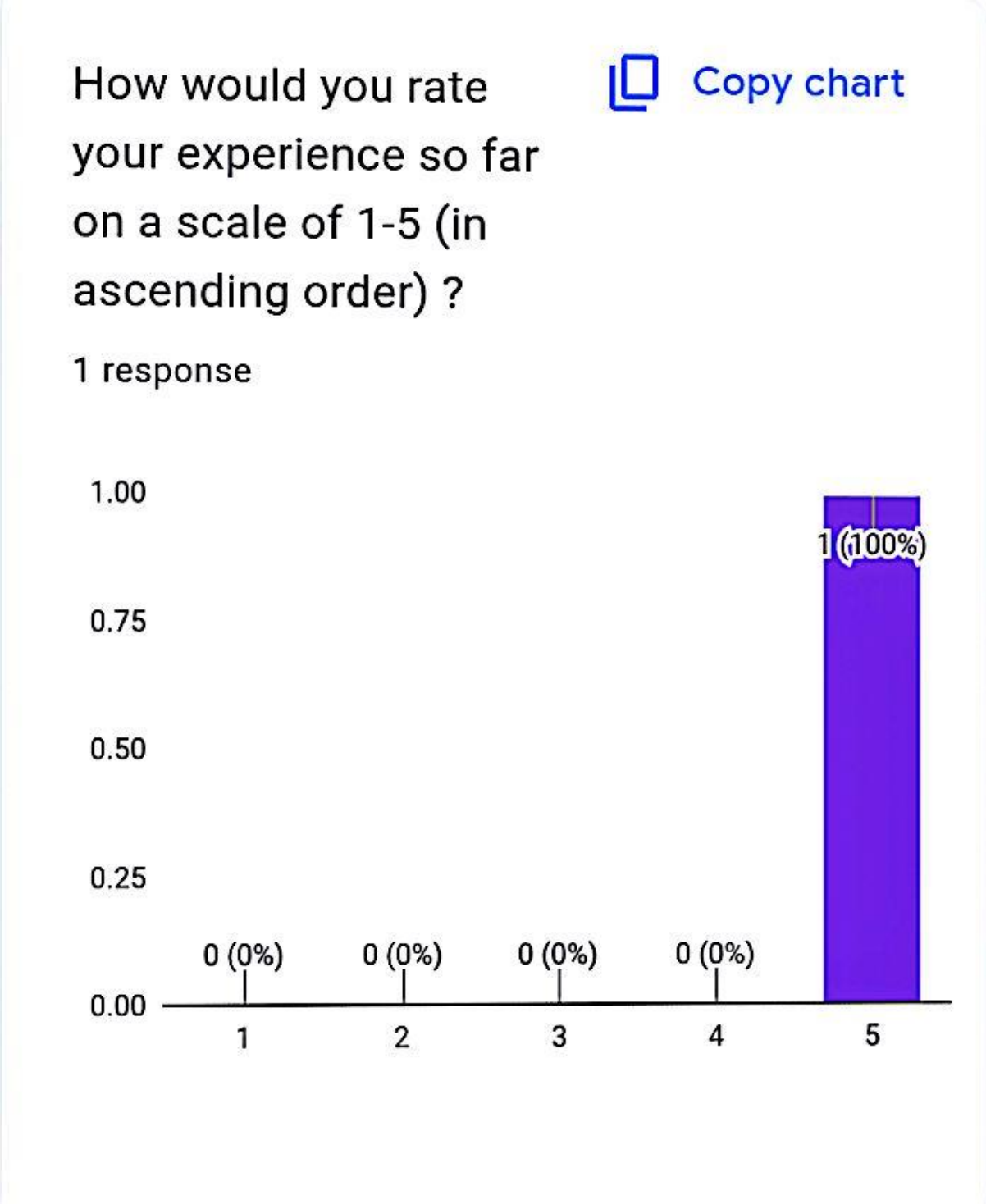

Figure 21 : Response chart

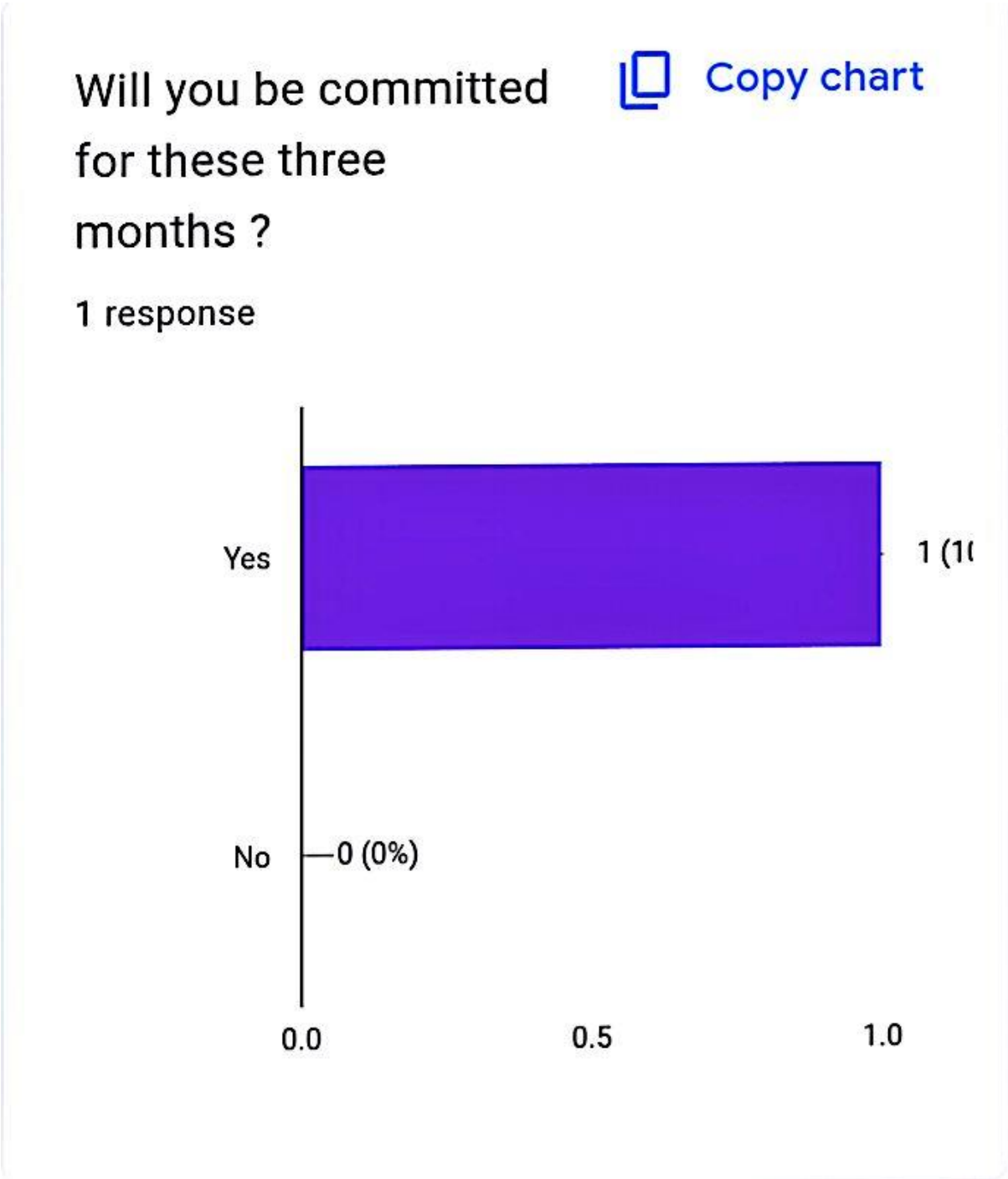

Figure 22 : Response chart II

- Individual: Scroll through each person's specific entry.

8.2 Linking Responses to Google Sheets

Click the green Spreadsheet icon in the Responses tab. This creates a live Google Sheet where every new response appears as a new row automatically.

Figure 23 : Green Spreadsheet icon

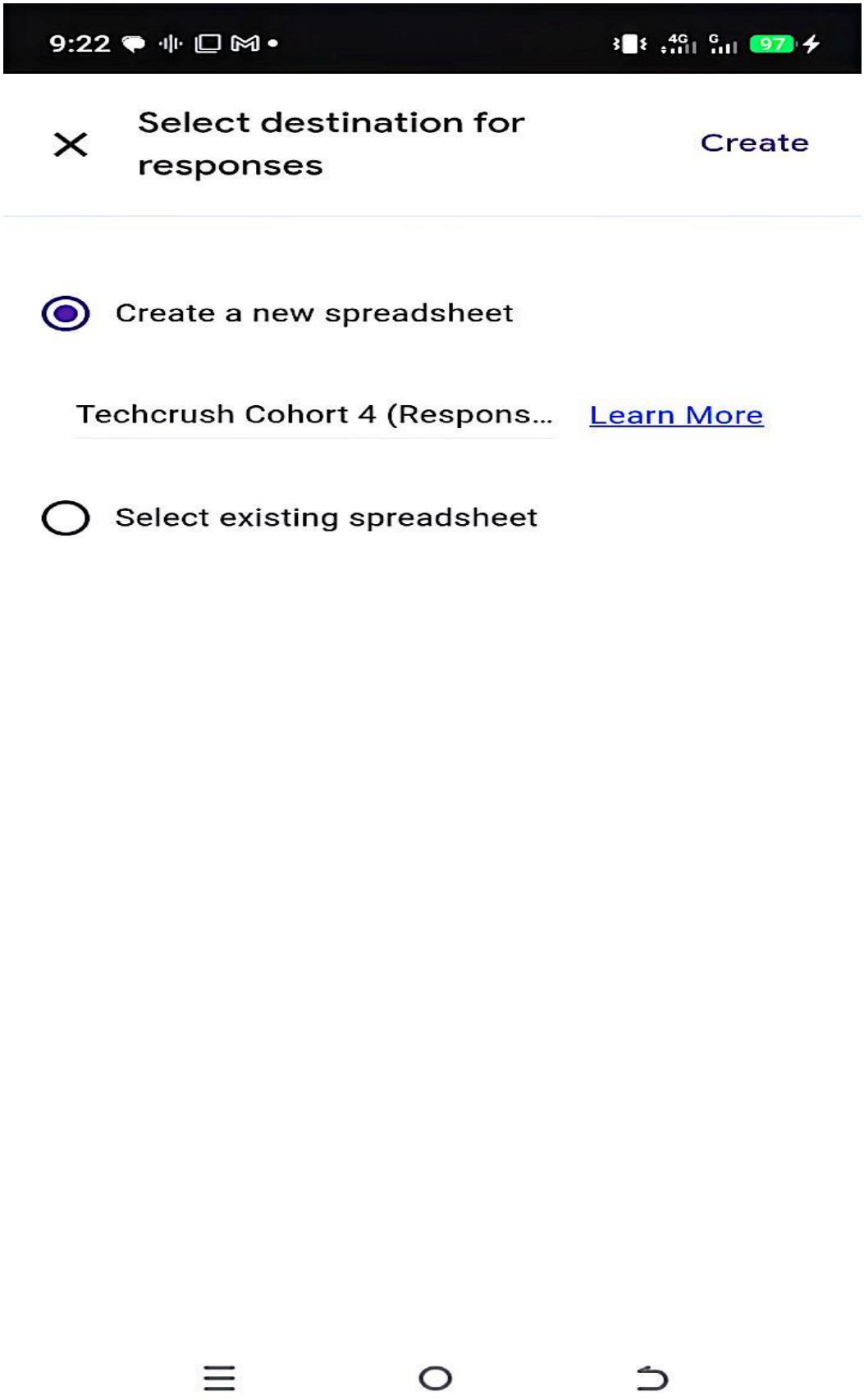

Figure 24 : Liking to Spreadsheet

Figure 25 : Automated response collation via Google spreadsheet

9. APPENDIX: KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

To speed up your design process in 2025, use these keyboard shortcuts for Google Forms. If you ever forget them, press Ctrl + / (Windows/ChromeOS) or ⌘ + / (Mac) while in the editor to see the full list on your screen.

9.1 Essential Design Actions

These shortcuts help you build your form without reaching for the floating sidebar

- **Add a New Question**: Ctrl + Shift + Enter (or hold Ctrl, then press i twice).
- **Add Title and Description**: Hold Ctrl, then press i then h.
- **Add Image**: Hold Ctrl, then press i then p.
- **Add Video**: Hold Ctrl, then press i then v.
- **Add Section**: Hold Ctrl, then press i then b.

9.2 Managing Questions & Items

- **Duplicate Item**: Ctrl + Shift + d.
- **Delete Item**: Alt + Shift + d.
- **Move Item Up**: Ctrl + Shift + k.
- **Move Item Down**: Ctrl + Shift + j.
- **Undo Action**: Ctrl + z.
- Redo Action: Ctrl + y or Ctrl + Shift + z.

9.3 Navigation & Menus

- **Preview Your Form**: Ctrl + Shift + p.
- **Open Settings Menu**: Ctrl + e.
- **Open Theme Dialog:** Alt + t (Windows/ChromeOS) or Ctrl + Option + t (Mac).
- **Move to Next Field:** Tab.

- **Move to Previous Field:** Shift + Tab.
- **Send Form**: Ctrl + Enter.

9.4 For Self-Grading Quizzes

- **Mark as Correct**: Ctrl + Shift + c.
- **Mark as Incorrect**: Ctrl + Shift + i.
- **Focus Grade Below/Above**: Ctrl + Shift + Down Arrow / Up Arrow.

Note: For Mac users, generally replace Ctrl with Command (⌘) and Alt with Option.

9.5 Building Forms with AI

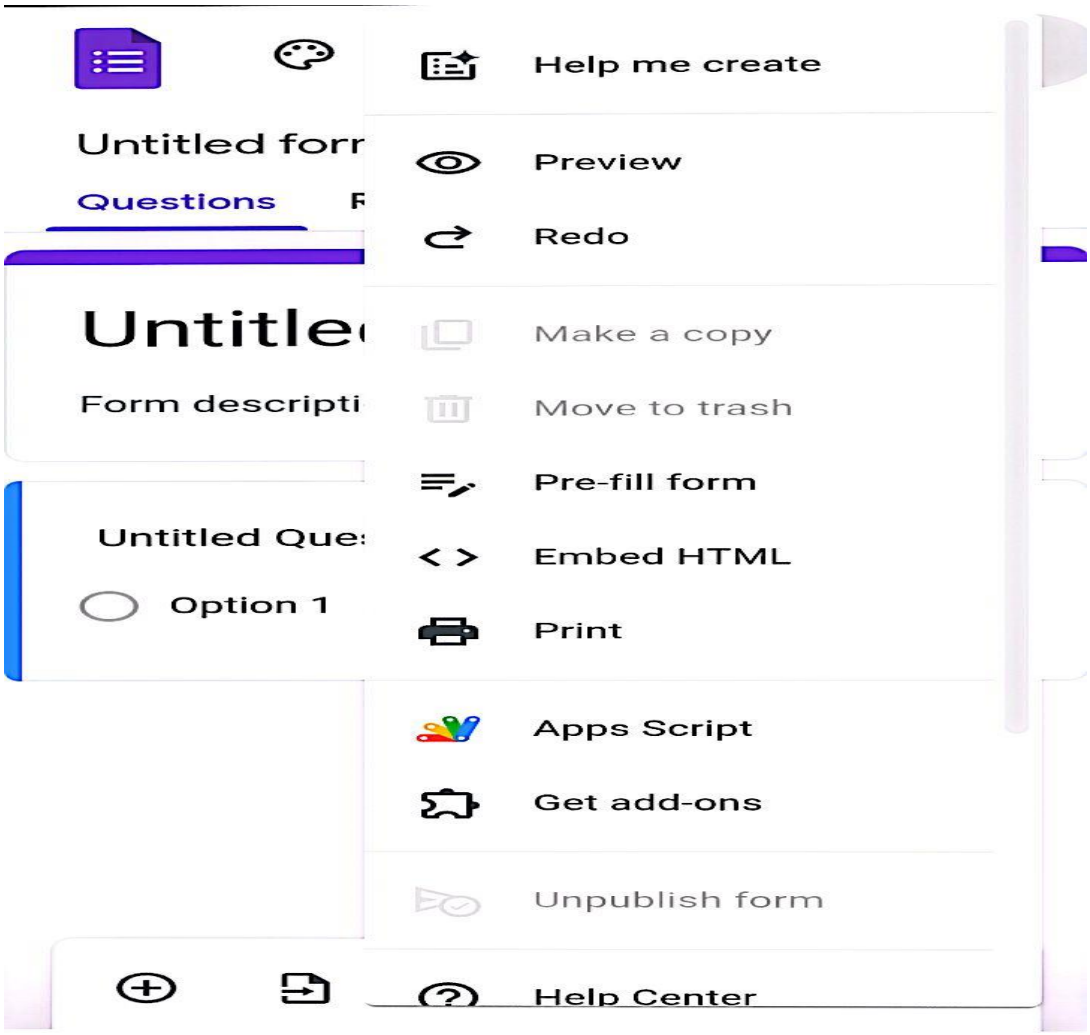

Figure 26: "Help me create" – AI button

In 2025, Google Forms integrated AI directly into the builder. This allows a user to create a full survey just by describing it in plain English

Using the "Help Me Create" Feature

When opening a new blank form at forms.new, a user will see an AI (magic wand) icon or a text box labeled "Help me create a form."

1. **Type Your Prompt:** Instead of adding questions one by one, a user can type a natural sentence into the AI box.

Example: "Create a customer feedback survey for a coffee shop that asks about drink quality, staff friendliness, and speed of service."

2. **Review the Draft:** The AI will instantly generate a list of relevant questions, choosing the best formats. Examples are multiple choice for "Yes/No" or linear scales for "Ratings."
3. **Refine and Insert:** A user can tell the AI to "make it shorter," "add more detail," or "change the tone to professional." Once satisfied, a user can click **Insert** to add the questions to the form.

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Why Use AI for Forms?

- **Speed:** It can reduce design time.
- **Smart Suggestions:** The AI often suggests important questions. Examples include "How did you hear about us?" or "Would you recommend us to a friend?"
- **Automatic Options:** If a user creates a multiple-choice question manually, the AI will often suggest "All of the above" or "Other."

By using AI, a user can focus on the goal of the survey instead of the mechanics of creating it.

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